

Datadog, Inc.

2026 Investor Day Recap

We left DDOG's Investor Day more confident in its position as a leading observability platform, and believe that AI will only make its unified platform more mission-critical over the long-term. Mgmt also reiterated its LT op. margin guide of 25%+.

Key Takeaway: DDOG's CEO emphasized that the company is looking to transition from not just an observability platform, but a control plane for AI-driven software workflows (enabling transparency, security, and autonomy over time). The Investor Day was less focused on its financials, and reinforced how AI is improving its LT opportunity with increased complexity, higher operational vulnerabilities, and broader addressable market.

We believe that DDOG's Bits SRE Agent could be a significant opportunity given its immediate ROI capabilities. We highlighted in our recent Observability Review (link [here](#)) that many public observability vendors, hyperscalers, and startups are making an effort to capture the AI SRE opportunity, given most enterprises today have yet to reach a truly "mature" stage in their SRE journey. While still early in their adoption cycle, we think these agents can deliver immediate value to organizations by saving on resolution time, outage duration, incident responses, and minimizing risk. DDOG noted that since becoming generally available in December 2025, Bits AI SRE has already been adopted by 2k+ customers to run 100k+ investigations (and with usage accelerating into January 2026). Mgmt noted that pricing for the agent is \$500 per 20 investigations, and that recent adoption of the tool includes Fortune 100 enterprises as well as AI-native startups.

Security: Emerging expansion opportunity with significant wallet-share potential. Datadog reiterated that its Security products have surpassed \$100M ARR and announced that the products are used by ~8.5k customers (inclusive of ~25% of the Fortune 500). Further, 70% of DDOG's \$1M+ customers use at least one security product, though this only represents ~2% of spend for those customers (see Fig. below). The company's VP of Security emphasized that enterprises having their observability and security on one platform can reduce silos (between teams), improve incident response times, and offers DDOG a durable expansion opportunity (particularly as AI increases the breadth and sophistication of potential vulnerabilities).

DDOG	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. Software	POSITIVE
Price Target	USD 165.00
Price (13-Feb-26)	USD 125.20
Potential Upside/Downside	+31.8%
Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research	

U.S. Software

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FIGURE 1. DDOG highlighted that security is a large, underpenetrated expansion opportunity.

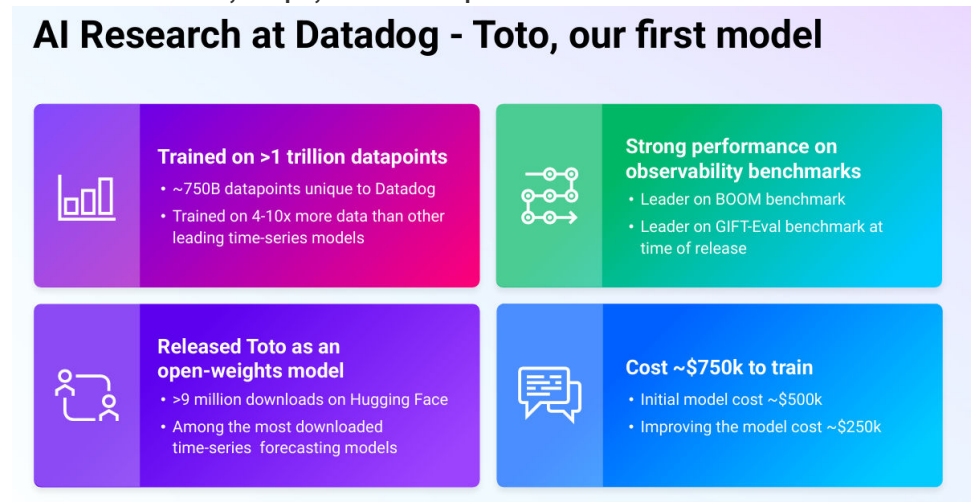


Source: Datadog

DDOG's data advantage: proprietary data and domain expertise emphasize AI advantage.

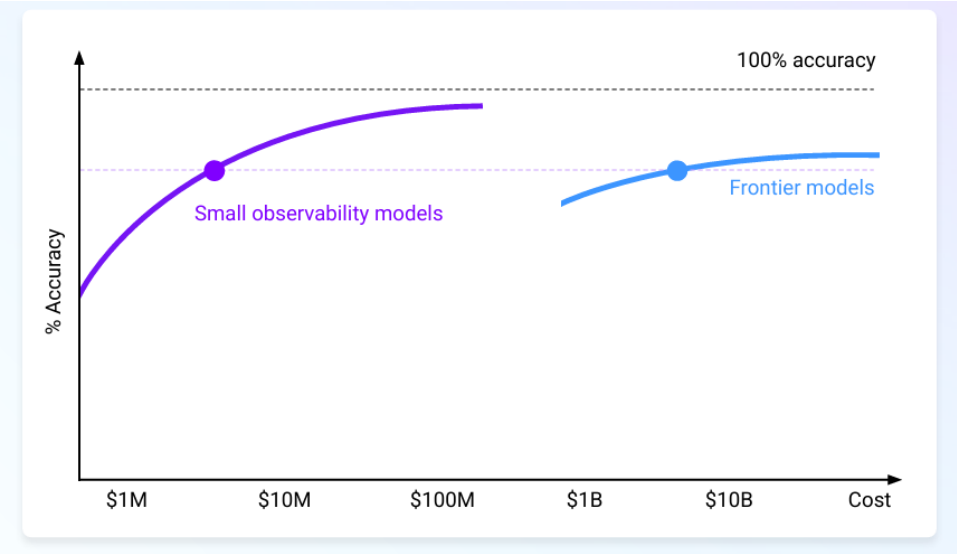
DDOG's CTO noted that the company has access to trillions of telemetry datapoints across many systems that enable it to train smaller, deep domain models that are more accurate and less costly than frontier models for observability / security workflows. Mgmt believes that while others can build models, DDOG's access to real production data and domain expertise is not easily replicated.

FIGURE 2. DDOG noted that its smaller, deep domain models that are trained on its own proprietary data are more accurate, cheaper, and faster compared to frontier models.



Source: Datadog

FIGURE 3. DDOG emphasized that while frontier models are impressive, model size is less important compared to data quality.



Source: Datadog

Continuing to invest in future growth opportunities, though financial discipline remains a focus LT. DDOG's CFO reaffirmed the long-term financial framework of a non-GAAP operating margin target of 25%+ (first provided at its 2024 Investor Day). The company has maintained ~80% non-GAAP gross margins, ~30% R&D spend as a % of revenue, and driven efficiencies throughout its S&M and G&A orgs. DDOG mgmt emphasized that AI and platform investments will continue to be balanced with cash generation, disciplined acquisition strategy (focused primarily on product / technical capabilities), and controlled net share dilution (target of 2.5-3%).

FIGURE 4. DDOG reaffirmed its long-term target of non-GAAP operating margin of 25%+ at its Investor Day.

Non-GAAP % ⁽¹⁾	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	Long-term goal
Gross Margin	79%	78%	80%	82%	82%	81%	
R&D	29%	30%	30%	30%	28%	30%	
S&M	31%	25%	25%	24%	24%	23%	
G&A	8%	7%	6%	6%	5%	5%	
Operating Margin	11%	16%	19%	23%	25%	22%	25%+
Free Cash Flow Margin	14%	24%	21%	28%	29%	27%	

Source: Datadog

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Datadog, Inc. (DDOG, 13-Feb-2026, USD 125.20), Overweight/Positive, CE/J

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Cloudflare, Inc. (NET)	Commerce (CMRC)	Confluent, Inc (CFLT)
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Dynatrace, Inc. (DT)	Elastic N.V. (ESTC)	EverCommerce Inc. (EVCN)
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PTC Inc. (PTC)	Rapid7 (RPD)	Rubrik, Inc. (RBRK)
SailPoint, Inc. (SAIL)	Salesforce.com Inc. (CRM)	SAP SE (SAP)
SentinelOne, Inc. (S)	ServiceNow, Inc. (NOW)	Similarweb Ltd. (SMWB)
Snowflake Computing (SNOW)	Sprinklr, Inc. (CXM)	Sprout Social, Inc. (SPT)
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UiPath, Inc. (PATH)	Varonis Systems, Inc. (VRNS)	Veeva Systems Inc. (VEEV)
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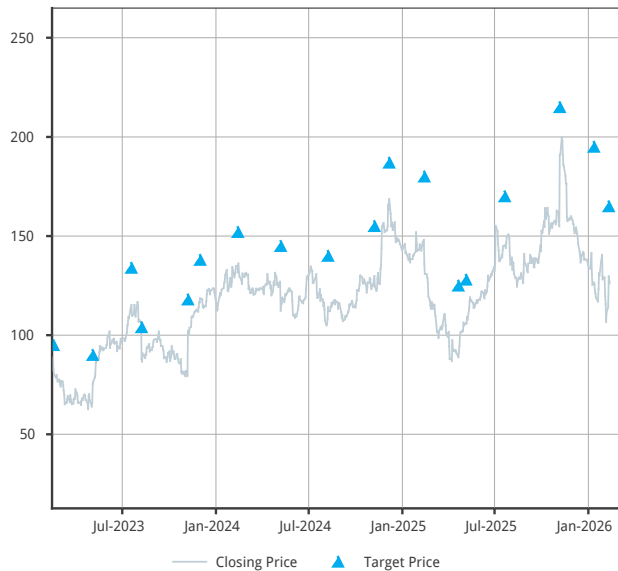
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **POSITIVE**

Closing Price: **USD 125.20** (13-Feb-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 13-Feb-2026)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
10-Feb-2026	114.01		165.00
12-Jan-2026	125.49		195.00
06-Nov-2025	190.82		215.00
21-Jul-2025	145.02		170.00
06-May-2025	105.70		128.00
21-Apr-2025	91.18		125.00
13-Feb-2025	135.89		180.00
06-Dec-2024	163.35		187.00
07-Nov-2024	129.79		155.00
08-Aug-2024	105.47		140.00
07-May-2024	126.97		145.00
13-Feb-2024	134.85		152.00
01-Dec-2023	116.57		138.00
07-Nov-2023	79.55		118.00
08-Aug-2023	106.30		104.00
19-Jul-2023	113.82		134.00
04-May-2023	75.40		90.00
16-Feb-2023	82.47		95.00

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Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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